

From Debut to Championships: Forecasting Competitive Percussion Outcomes

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Abstract

This paper introduces a historical dataset of Southern California Percussion Alliance scores and studies whether an ensemble's debut performance predicts its relative championship outcome. The final abstract should state the cohort, target, models, temporal holdout, headline result, and principal limitation.

Keywords

competitive percussion, performance forecasting, judged competition, longitudinal data, regression

1 Introduction

Competitive indoor percussion combines athletic execution, musical performance, and visual design. Its scores are expert judgments rather than direct physical measurements, and ensembles are expected to improve as a season progresses. This creates a useful forecasting question: how much of a group's eventual competitive outcome is already visible at its debut?

2 Related Work

Related work will be added after a reproducible literature search. Sources must be verified and cited from references.bib.

3 Dataset and Exploratory Analysis

The project database contains 4,441 performances and 56,910 score records covering 2017–2026 except 2021 [1]. The final version of this section will distinguish raw performances from derived identities, events, season weeks, and judge blocks.

4 Predictive Task and Methods

The primary task predicts a track-season's class-relative championship outcome using only information available at its debut performance.

5 Results

This section will be generated from the frozen 2025–2026 holdout evaluation.

6 Secondary Analysis

Secondary analyses examine temporal score calibration and, if supported, persistent judge–ensemble residuals.

7 Limitations

The analysis cannot observe performer membership, staff continuity, rehearsal time, budget, repertoire difficulty, or show completion. Its findings are predictive associations and should not be interpreted causally.

8 Conclusion

The conclusion will summarize how much championship information is present at debut and identify the most important limitation for future work.

References

- [1] scpadb project. 2026. Historical SCPA Competitive Percussion Scoring Database. Project dataset and software repository. Accessed June 2026.